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Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. Unmet expectations: How chief executive officer dismissal affects corporate reputation

Authors: Jaegoo Lim, E. Geoffrey Love, Michael K. Bednar

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70104](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70104)

Published: 2026-05-31

Keywords: CEO dismissal, CEO/top management, corporate governance, corporate reputation, expectancy violation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Corporate Reputation
- **Theories:** Expectancy Violation Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: CEO dismissal is a high-stakes governance decision, yet its implications for corporate reputations remain underexplored. We develop theory explaining how dismissals damage corporate reputation through perceptual processes that arise from features of and reactions to the practice itself, distinct from effects attributable to dismissal's (much studied) economic and strategic consequences. Drawing on expectancy violation theory, we argue that dismissals become salient and generate negative reactions because they deviate from the preferred norm of planned succession and also highlight firm-level problems, and these factors prompt reputational reassessment. The findings support this prediction: dismissals significantly damage corporate reputation even after controlling for financial performance. This damage intensifies when dismissed CEOs have won awards, received extensive media coverage, or led high-performing firms. Managerial Summary: Firing a CEO is one of the most consequential decisions that boards make, yet we know little about how this action affects a firm's reputation. We find that CEO dismissals meaningfully damage corporate reputation, even after accounting for the firm's financial situation. This damage appears to occur for two reasons: dismissals deviate from the preferred approach of a planned leadership transition, and they Received: 30 April 2026 Revised: 30 April 2026 Accepted: 19 May 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70104 Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–26. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. 1 draw attention to underlying problems at the firm. The reputational harm intensifies when the dismissed CEO had won industry awards, received extensive media coverage, or led a firm that was performing well. These findings suggest that boards should consider the potential reputational costs of dismissing a CEO alongside the anticipated strategic benefits. **KEYWORDS** CEO dismissal, CEO/top management, corporate governance, corporate reputation, expectancy violation 1 |

□ Lim - Unmet expectations How chief executive officer dismissal affects corporate reput.pdf

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. Christel Lane and M. Pilar Opazo. Cultural Flows in High-End Cuisine: From the Periphery to the Center

Authors: Daniel B. SandsKenan-Flagler Business School, The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261459381](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261459381)

Published: 2026-06-10

Abstract not available. □ School - Christel Lane and M. Pilar Opazo. Cultural Flows in High-End Cuisine From the Pe.pdf

Academy of Management Journal

1. Loosening the Theoretical Reins: A Case for Phenomenon-Driven Research in AMJ

Authors: Anne L. J. Ter Wal, Laura M. Little, Matthew G. Grimes, Quinetta Roberson

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2026.4003](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2026.4003)

Published: 2026-06-03

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Management Theory, Research Methodology, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Phenomenon-Driven Research, Inductive Theory Building, Theoretical Contribution

Abstract:

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□ Wal - Loosening the Theoretical Reins A Case for Phenomenon-Driven Research in AMJ.pdf

2. The Social Attribution of Innovation: Uncovering the Heads Behind the Guillotine

Authors: Paolo Aversa, Paul Gouvard, Maria A. Makarova

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.0314](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.0314)

Published: 2026-06-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Social Construction of Technology, Organizational Theory, History of Technology
- **Theories:** Social Attribution Theory, Process Model of Attribution, Co-construction, Evaluation-Attribution Spiral

Abstract:

Popular narratives often attribute innovations to a few "heroic" figures. Although scholarship has challenged this myth, it typically treats attribution as an issue of credit allocation, separating innovation production from innovator recognition. As a result, we lack an integrated account of how innovations and innovators become progressively linked through social processes of attribution. We address this gap through a micro-historical study of the guillotine, a beheading machine enduringly attributed to—and named after—Dr. Joseph-Ignace Guillotin, a humanist, physician, and politician who did not, in fact, invent it. Analyzing debates on equality in penal reform during the French Revolution (1788–1792), we develop a process model of attribution grounded in the co-construction of innovations and innovators. We theorize how audiences' evaluations of a contributor's engagement with a novel solution escalate into an evaluation-attribution spiral that crystallizes the innovator-innovation link. Our model identifies the mapping of contributors' engagement onto value-laden problem dimensions as a key mechanism, and shows why, once crystallized, attribution persists even as the innovation's meaning shifts—transferring credit or blame to the attributed actor regardless of material involvement. In doing so, we advance research on innovation production, innovator recognition, and the social construction of technology.

□ Aversa - The Social Attribution of Innovation Uncovering the Heads Behind the Guillotine

3. ChatGPT, a Hype That Teaches: Generative AI and the Collective Accumulation of Technology Literacy on Social Media

Authors: Hassan Md. Hamadi, Anna Brattström

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.0536](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.0536)

Published: 2026-06-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Information Systems, Innovation Management, Strategic Management, Social Media Studies
- **Theories:** Sensemaking Theory, Hype Cycles, Collective Knowledge Creation, Relational Publics

Abstract:

The 2022 launch of ChatGPT triggered a wave of social media discussion about generative AI. Drawing on 215,279 posts from five months after this launch, we extend prior accounts of hype as a vehicle for strategic resource mobilization to develop a theory of hype as collective sensemaking and knowledge creation. Existing models rest on a fixed relational architecture: knowledgeable actors leverage information asymmetries to project visions, directing expectations top down. ChatGPT collapsed this architecture by making generative AI accessible, democratizing technology evaluation; meanwhile, social media emerged as the arena where relational publics could form, driving vision formation and contestation around generative AI from the bottom up, reshaping how a nascent technology acquired meaning. Combining grounded theory with computational text analysis, we develop a process model on the role of relational publics in hypes. We explain how collective knowledge accumulates through traceable conceptual prototyping, testing a technology's capability and proposing meaning simultaneously, and how, when this knowledge crosses a technology literacy threshold, hype transitions from an expanding to a containing phase. The model advances our understanding of how novel technologies diffuse when crowds simultaneously co-construct visionary imaginaries and practical knowledge, and of the role social media plays in this process.

□ Hamadi - ChatGPT, a Hype That Teaches Generative AI and the Collective Accumulation of Te.pdf

4. Trauma at Work: Reframing Experiences to Sustain Engagement

Authors: Madeleine Rauch, Shaz Ansari

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2023.1101](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2023.1101)

Published: 2026-06-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Occupational Psychology, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Construal-Level Theory, Coping Theory, Temporal Reframing, Work Engagement

Abstract:

Experiencing trauma in extreme contexts (e.g., areas affected by war, famine, or disease) can undermine professionals' ability to cope, and remain engaged, with work. Prior research has highlighted coping strategies, such as detachment from trauma. However, less attention has been given to how professionals cope in demoralizing contexts, where trauma is persistent, detachment is difficult, and hope for impact erodes. Drawing on 73 diaries, 146 interviews, field observations, and archival data from Medecins Sans Frontieres (Doctors Without Borders), we show how professionals cope by temporally reframing their experiences—anchoring in the past or future to reinterpret their experience, and reorienting their agency to sustain engagement in the present. Building on construallevel theory, we identify three reframing pathways that enable professionals to remain engaged over time. Such temporal reframing influences not only how professionals cope but also whether they return to fieldwork or redirect purpose to broader systemic change and policymaking. We contribute to the literatures on trauma and coping by theorizing temporal reframing as a cognitive-emotional coping approach that reorients disoriented agency and explains divergent pathways of sustained engagement or redirected purpose.

□ Rauch - Trauma at Work Reframing Experiences to Sustain Engagement.pdf

5. Endogenous Sources of Uncertainty: The Role of Firm Status in Shaping Financially Uncertain Investments

Authors: Anran Li, Michael Jensen

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.0427](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.0427)

Published: 2026-06-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Sociology, Corporate Finance
- **Theories:** Status Theory, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Performance Feedback Theory

Abstract:

This study examines the relationship between firm status and investment activities. Focusing specifically on financially uncertain investments, we argue that middle-status firms engage in more financially uncertain investments than low- and high-status firms. Moreover, the extent to which firms perform above historical and social benchmarks mitigates the relationship between status and financially uncertain investments. We find broad support for our arguments in a longitudinal sample of privately controlled listed Chinese firms traded on the Shanghai and Shenzhen stock exchanges. Specifically, we find that social benchmarks based on comparisons to firms in the same industry and status group mitigate the inverted U-shaped relationship between status and financially uncertain investments. Moreover, the effect of industry benchmarks, not status benchmarks, is stronger than the effect of historical benchmarks, that is, comparisons to own past performance.

□ Li - Endogenous Sources of Uncertainty The Role of Firm Status in Shaping Financially.pdf

Academy of Management Review

1. Opening and Closing the Configurational Theorizing Gateway with Explicit Decision Rules—An Extension of Campbell and Fiss’ “Tackling the Complexity Challenge: When and How to Engage in Configurational and Hybrid Theorizing”

Authors: Yannick Griep, Kevin S. Cruz

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2026.0121](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2026.0121)

Published: 2026-06-10

Abstract not available. □ Griep - Opening and Closing the Configurational Theorizing Gateway with Explicit Decisio.pdf

2. Triadic Attentional Processing and Buildup of Joint Attentional Engagement in Emergent Strategic Initiatives

Authors: Olli-Pekka Kauppila, Eero Vaara

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2024.0120](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2024.0120)

Published: 2026-06-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Strategy Process, Organizational Behavior, Micro-foundations
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Social Cognition, Social Agency

Abstract:

The attention-based view (ABV) posits that strategic actions are shaped by the issues members attend to. Seminal theorizing explains top management’ s role in distributing and enacting attention, but we know less about how organizational attention emerges through bottom-up strategic initiatives. Whereas traditional ABV adopts a dyadic approach to attending (attendee and object of attention), we introduce a triadic approach (attendee, coattendee, and joint object) to explain the buildup of joint attentional engagement in bottom-up strategic initiatives. Drawing on research on social cognition and social agency, we develop a three-fold process model comprising: (1) brokering and rhetorical work as key forms of triadic agency through which individuals initiate and sustain joint attentional engagement; (2) cognitive alignment and shared trust as mechanisms through which a collectively attending entity and collective attention emerge, enabling a jointly attended issue to develop into a strategic initiative; and (3) attracting and engaging broader organizational attention amid competing issues and initiatives, thereby connecting the emergent strategic initiative to the organization’ s broader strategic agenda. By theorizing organizational attention as a joint, emergent, and recursive phenomenon, we advance both ABV and strategy process research, thereby offering a micro-foundational explanation of how bottom-up initiatives gain traction and enable strategic change.

Organization Science

1. The Cybernetic Teammate: A Field Experiment on Generative AI and Teamwork

Authors: Fabrizio Dell'Acqua, Charles Ayoubi, Hila Lifshitz, Raffaella Sadun, Ethan Mollick, Lilach Mollick, Yi Han, Jeff Goldman, Hari Nair, Stew Taub, Karim R. Lakhani

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2025.20702](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20702)

Published: 2026-06-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Organizational Behavior, Technology Management, New Product Development
- **Theories:** Human-AI Collaboration, Team Dynamics, Creative Problem Solving

Abstract:

We examine how artificial intelligence (AI) impacts three core pillars of collaboration—performance enhancement, expertise integration, and social engagement—through a preregistered field experiment with 791 professionals at Procter & Gamble, a global consumer packaged goods company. Working on real product innovation challenges, professionals were randomly assigned to work either with or without AI, and either individually or with another professional in new product development teams. Our findings show that (1) AI significantly enhances performance: individuals with AI matched the performance of teams without AI, suggesting that AI can effectively replicate certain benefits of human collaboration. Moreover, (2) AI helps bridge functional silos: without AI, research and development professionals tended to suggest more technical solutions, whereas commercial professionals leaned toward commercially oriented proposals. Professionals using AI produced more balanced solutions, regardless of their professional background. (3) AI's language-based interface prompted more positive self-reported emotional responses among participants, suggesting it can fulfill part of the social and motivational role traditionally offered by human teammates. Finally, decomposing the innovation process suggests that AI primarily enhances the quality of generated ideas, shifting the distribution of creative output upward, whereas human judgment retains value in evaluative selection. This finding highlights the multiple and complementary roles that human and AI partners can play in new product development tasks and creative problem solving. More generally, our results suggest that AI adoption in knowledge work affects not only performance but also how expertise and sociality appear within teams, offering insights into the impact of generative AI on collaborative work within organizations. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. You are free to copy, distribute, transmit and adapt this work, but you must attribute this work as "Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20702>, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>." Funding: Funding for this research was provided in part by Harvard Business School. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20702>.

□ Dell'Acqua - The Cybernetic Teammate A Field Experiment on Generative AI and Teamwork.pdf

2. Revisiting Stock Market Signals as a Lens for Patent Valuation

Authors: Ashish Arora, Sharon Belenzon, Elia Ferracuti, Jay Prakash Nagar

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2025.20570](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20570)

Published: 2026-06-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Strategic Management, Research Methods, Intellectual Property
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Market-based Valuation, Measurement Error Analysis

Abstract:

Estimating the private value of patents is important, yet challenging. By developing a method based on stock market returns to produce estimates of individual patent values, Kogan et al. [Kogan L, Papanikolaou D, Seru A, Stoffman N (2017) Technological innovation, resource allocation, and growth. *Quart. J. Econom.* 132(2):665–712] (KPSS) opened venues for new research. We characterize the measurement error in KPSS—the difference between the latent true patent value and the corresponding KPSS estimate—and show it is negatively correlated with the latent true patent value. We then investigate the use of KPSS estimates in two different applications. First, we show that using KPSS values to gauge differences in value between different patent groups is internally inconsistent and introduces attenuation bias. We offer two solutions: extending the original KPSS method to allow for patents to be drawn from two distinct value distributions, and using abnormal stock market returns. We compare both to the original KPSS estimates in several contexts relevant to the organizational scholars, such as patents by large and small teams, scientific and nonscientific patents, and offshored and domestically invented patents. Second, we show that KPSS yield unbiased estimates when used as explanatory variables. These analyses allow us to characterize the main trade-offs associated with each approach, and offer practical guidance to researchers. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/ORSC.2025.20570>.

□ Arora - Revisiting Stock Market Signals as a Lens for Patent Valuation.pdf

3. Working in the Age of Ubiquitous Scrutiny: How External Monitoring Legitimizes Organizational Monitoring

Authors: Elizabeth A. Hood, Jacqueline N. Hood, Lyndon E. Garrett

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2023.18361](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18361)

Published: 2026-06-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Organizational Behavior, Sociology of Work
- **Theories:** Organizational Control, Legitimacy Theory, Sensemaking, Relational Theory of Control

Abstract:

Extant research finds that workers often develop negative or ambivalent perceptions of organizational monitoring and thus engage in acts of resistance. However, this work largely assumes that organizational monitoring occurs in isolation, overlooking how the growing presence of external monitoring may fundamentally alter how workers experience organizational monitoring. To investigate this dynamic, we conducted a qualitative study of a U.S. police department where officers faced both organizational monitoring via body cameras and external monitoring via citizens' cell phones. In the context of external monitoring, we find that officers experienced organizational monitoring as both unreasonable scrutiny and insulating protection that buffered against external scrutiny. To manage their resulting ambivalence toward organizational monitoring, officers disassociated their perceptions of the monitoring technology from policies, which enabled them to repurpose the technology. Officers' uses of the monitoring technology triggered them to reevaluate the organizational monitoring system as legitimate within the context of external scrutiny. Based on our findings, we develop theory of how control is relationally constituted and legitimated, showing how control mechanisms such as organizational monitoring may shift from coercive to enabling in the context of ubiquitous external scrutiny. We also contribute to extant literature by identifying how workers may manage ambivalence toward organizational monitoring through functional disassociation, separating their perceptions of monitoring policies and technology. Further, we extend existing theory by unpacking how workers' use of the monitoring technology, combined with external scrutiny as a comparative frame, may facilitate workers' reevaluation of the organizational monitoring system as a legitimate source of oversight. Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18361>.

□ Hood - Working in the Age of Ubiquitous Scrutiny How External Monitoring Legitimizes Or.pdf

4. Outsiders at the Helm: When Institutional Outsiderness Helps or Hurts Public Leaders' Crisis Management Performance

Authors: Lin Jiang, Dong Liu, Yan Yu

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.18656](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18656)

Published: 2026-06-05

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Public Administration, Crisis Management, Strategic Leadership
- **Theories:** Strategic Leadership Theory, Institutional Theory, Contingency Theory

Abstract:

Institutional outsiders have become increasingly common in public administrations, coinciding with a growing prevalence of public crises. Yet we know little about whether and under what conditions leaders with limited political experience perform well or poorly during such crises. Drawing on strategic leadership and institutional change research, we develop competing hypotheses and a contingency framework that explains how public leaders' institutional outsidership shapes their crisis management performance. We argue that outsidership can either hinder or facilitate crisis response, depending on conditions that affect leaders' ability to effectively enact institutional change. Specifically, institutional outsidership is more likely to hinder crisis management when leaders (i) operate in highly institutionalized environments, (ii) lack relevant crisis management experience, and (iii) hold low precrisis social approval. Using data on U.S. state governors during the COVID-19 pandemic (Study 1), we find that governors' institutional outsidership is associated with lower crisis management performance, especially under these conditions. However, when institutionalization is low, outsidership is associated with higher crisis management performance. We conducted a second study with a different sample and crisis context (U.S. state governors during the 2008 financial crisis) and partially replicate the results from Study 1. Together, our results suggest that whether institutional outsidership is a liability or an asset for crisis management depends on contextual and leader-level conditions. These findings contribute to research on crisis leadership, strategic leadership, and public administration. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/2024.18656>.

□ Jiang - Outsiders at the Helm When Institutional Outsidership Helps or Hurts Public Lead.pdf

5. Shareholder Activism and Corporate Political Activity: A Governance Systems Perspective

Authors: Mark R. DesJardine, Wei Shi, Zhihui Sun

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.19974](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19974)

Published: 2026-06-02

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Political Activity
- **Theories:** Governance Systems Perspective, Shareholder Activism

Abstract:

Research documents that firms targeted by financially motivated shareholder activists often reduce spending in areas with uncertain or delayed payoffs. Yet, it is unclear whether this pattern extends to corporate political activity (CPA), particularly lobbying—an investment that is relatively inexpensive and can generate substantial benefits in the short run. We investigate how governance conditions shape the influence of block-holding activism on firm lobbying expenditures. Drawing on an emerging systems perspective on shareholder activism, we theorize how boards (as capability providers) and nonactivist shareholders (as sources of support) shape firms' lobbying behavior amid shareholder activism. Using panel data on 4,991 U.S. public firms, we find that the influence of block-holding activism on lobbying depends on the governance context; firms with more political directors and greater ownership by lobbying-active shareholders sustain their lobbying following activism, whereas firms without these governance features reduce it. The influence of political directors is amplified when they have greater bandwidth, and the influence of lobbying-active shareholders is strengthened when they have held their positions longer. Our study contributes to CPA research by demon-

strating that governance systems determine how activism shapes firms' political strategies and extends the systems perspective on activism into nonmarket domains of strategy. Funding: M. R. DesJardine acknowledges research support from The Wharton School's Impact, Value, and Sustainable Business Initiative. W. Shi acknowledges financial support from the University of Miami Provost Research Award. Z. Sun acknowledges financial support from the National Natural Science Foundation of China [Grant 72502157] as well as the Humanities and Social Science Foundation of the Ministry of Education of China [Grant 24YJC630189]. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19974>.

□ DesJardine - Shareholder Activism and Corporate Political Activity A Governance Systems Persp.pdf

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. From Personal to Collective Powers: Towards Gender Inclusivity in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems

Authors: Iulia Stroila, Elina Isakova, Helle Neergaard

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261450569](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261450569)

Published: 2026-06-07

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, Women's Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Critical Realism, Morphogenetic Approach, Social Capital Theory

Abstract:

Entrepreneurship research increasingly seeks to explain how systemic change towards gender inclusivity unfolds. Drawing on a critical realist case study, we develop a morphogenetic account of how such change becomes possible within entrepreneurial ecosystems through structural and cultural conditioning, social interaction, and structural and cultural elaboration. We show that bonding and bridging function as collective, agential mechanisms through which women and their allies reflexively contest gendered constraints and mobilise resource gatekeepers, thereby enabling shifts in ecosystem norms and practices over time. By doing so, the study bridges women's entrepreneurship, ecosystem scholarship, and critical realism through a processual explanation of change.

□ Stroila - From Personal to Collective Powers Towards Gender Inclusivity in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems

2. Institutional Space-Making for Equity in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems: Evidence from U.S. Cities

Authors: Qingfang Wang, Sua Kim, Scott Taylor

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261450579](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261450579)

Published: 2026-06-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, Institutional Theory
- **Theories:** Institutional Entrepreneurship, Institutional Space-making, Institutional Redesign

Abstract:

Entrepreneurial ecosystems (EE) are widely viewed as engines of innovation, economic development, and opportunity, yet prior research offers limited insight into how equity is institutionally produced and sustained, particularly for minority- and women-owned businesses. We introduce institutional space-making—the purposeful construction of governance, relational, and organizational environments that enable equitable participation—as a core institutional mechanism for ecosystem redesign. Drawing on a multi-city

case analysis of the Ascend program across 13 U.S. cities, we identify 3 interrelated processes: (a) structural redesign that confronts exclusionary rules, routines, and evaluative logics; (b) relational mobilization through institutional entrepreneurship that assembles cross-sector coalitions to reconfigure resource flows and opportunity structures; and (c) organizational and implementation practices that embed cultural responsiveness through trust-building and adaptive coordination. Findings show that inclusive ecosystems emerge when these processes are jointly enacted, linking ecosystem design with everyday implementation. Our study advances EE theory by specifying how equity is produced through institutional redesign and offers actionable guidance for policymakers and ecosystem builders seeking durable inclusion.

□ Wang - Institutional Space-Making for Equity in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems Evidence fro.pdf

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Hatching and fledging? A meta-analysis of the performance effects of business incubators

Authors: Jorge-Vinicio Murillo-Rojas, Jan Brinckmann, Marc van Essen

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70032](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70032)

Published: 2026-06-12

Keywords: incubator, meta-analysis, ownership, performance, resource support

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management, Business Incubation
- **Theories:** Buffering and Bridging Mechanisms, Resource Dependence Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Business incubators are among the most widely implemented instruments to foster entrepreneurship. Yet empirical evidence on their effectiveness remains fragmented and often contradictory. Limited research systematically compares how different types of incubators influence multiple venture performance outcomes, including innovation, survival, growth, profitability, and employment. In this meta-analysis of 39 empirical studies encompassing 55,219 firms, we synthesize the relationship between business incubation and different venture performance dimensions. Our results reveal a significant positive overall effect, moderated by the types of support mechanisms provided and the incubators' ownership identities. We find strong positive effects on innovation and a modest but statistically significant effect on growth, whereas effects on survival, profitability, and employment are weaker and, in part, statistically insignificant. Managerial Summary: Policymakers regularly invest in incubators, yet uncertainty remains about which models deliver meaningful value to supported firms. Drawing on evidence from 39 studies covering more than 55,000 firms, this meta- Received: 4 March 2026 Revised: 9 April 2026 Accepted: 15 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70032 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–40. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 analysis shows that incubators can improve innovation and firm growth, while effects on survival, profitability, and job creation are limited or inconsistent. Incubator design and governance are central drivers of support effectiveness. Programs that emphasize bridging—that is, linking startups to investors, customers, and expert networks—generate stronger outcomes than models focused primarily on buffering, such as subsidized space or administrative support. Private and university incubators outperform public models, which often face bureaucratic constraints. These findings provide guidance on how managers and policymakers can align an incubator's support model and governance with the specific outcomes they seek to achieve. K E Y W O R D S incubator, meta-analysis, ownership, performance, resource support 1 |

□ Murillo-Rojas - Hatching and fledging A meta-analysis of the performance effects of business inc.pdf

2. Why theory matters for causal inference? Rethinking endogeneity in entrepreneurship research

Authors: Daniel Tzabbar

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70033](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70033)

Published: 2026-06-09

Keywords: causal inference, endogeneity, entrepreneurship research, structural causal modeling, theory development

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methods, Econometrics
- **Theories:** Structural Causal Modeling, Causal Inference

Abstract:

Endogeneity in entrepreneurship research is often treated as a statistical complication addressable through advanced econometric tools. This commentary argues that such an approach overlooks a deeper issue: endogeneity is conceptual before it is statistical. Because entrepreneurial phenomena involve reciprocal relationships, evolving mechanisms, and context-dependent processes, biased estimates frequently stem from underspecified constructs and unclear causal logic. I contend that theory, sufficiently precise to specify constructs, articulate mechanisms, and establish temporal ordering and boundary conditions, is the primary tool for reducing endogeneity in empirical estimation. Integrating theory with structural causal modeling and rigorous empirical design strengthens identification while enhancing explanatory value. I conclude with practical recommendations for scholars, emphasizing theory's central role in producing credible, cumulative knowledge in entrepreneurship research. **Managerial Summary:** Entrepreneurs and managers often rely on data to understand what drives venture success, but data alone can be misleading if the underlying assumptions about cause and effect are unclear. This article explains why strong theory—clear ideas about how and why things work—is essential for drawing reliable conclusions from data. **Received:** 26 November 2025 **Revised:** 13 May 2026 **Accepted:** 14 May 2026 **DOI:** 10.1002/sej.70033 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–29. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej **1 evidence.** Endogeneity, a common problem in business research, occurs when factors influence each other in ways that make results appear stronger or weaker than they are. By using theory to map out mechanisms and likely confounding factors, leaders can make better decisions about which actions truly create value. The article also shows how tools like causal modeling can combine conceptual clarity with rigorous analysis, helping organizations design strategies that are both evidence-based and trustworthy. **KEYWORDS** causal inference, endogeneity, entrepreneurship research, structural causal modeling, theory development 1 |

□ Tzabbar - Why theory matters for causal inference Rethinking endogeneity in entrepreneurship

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Keeping Up With the Times? Rethinking Social Evaluations Research Under Contemporary Technological and Sociopolitical Forces

Authors: Marco Clemente, Michael Etter, Yuliya Snihur, Gokhan Ertug, Graffin Scott, Anastasiya Zavyalova

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70121](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70121)

Published: 2026-06-08

Keywords: activism, artificial intelligence, audience, digital technology, legitimacy, media, polarization, reputation, social evaluations, status, stigma, trust

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Social Evaluations
- **Theories:** Social Evaluations Research, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Abstract The context within which social evaluations form has been fundamentally altered by contemporary forces, such as digital technologies, polarization, activism, politicization of business, and geopolitical tensions. While research on social evaluations has generated rich insights into the formation and development of constructs, such as legitimacy, status, reputation, stigma, trust, and celebrity, much of this work has been developed under the assumptions of relative stability, coherent audiences, and well-defined intermediary roles. These assumptions are increasingly challenged in this changing context, requiring us to rethink the formation and management of social evaluations. The articles in this special issue focus on these changes. Building on these contributions, this introductory article develops a research agenda across seven interconnected areas: the stability and fragility of social evaluations, audience fragmentation and convergence, the reshaping of the intermediary landscape, construct interrelationships, range and extension of constructs, the measurement of social evaluations, and their underlying foundations. We discuss how these transformations affect not only organizations and evaluative processes, but also the societal impact of social evaluations. Overall, this editorial provides a framework to guide future research in a field undergoing profound transition.

□ Clemente - Keeping Up With the Times Rethinking Social Evaluations Research Under Contempor.pdf

2. Hidden in Plain Sight: Conceptualizing Platform Auxiliaries and Their Conflicting Impacts on Platforms' Value Architecture

Authors: Donato Cutolo, Andrew Hargadon, Martin Kenney

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70123](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70123)

Published: 2026-06-07

Keywords: complementors, platform architecture, platform auxiliaries, platform ecosystems, platform entrepreneurship, platform governance, platforms

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Platform Strategy
- **Theories:** Platform Theory, Value Architecture, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

Abstract This paper introduces the concept of platform auxiliaries to identify a set of actors that provide independent resources explicitly designed to support complementors in their value creation and capture activities. Platform auxiliaries capitalize on unmet needs of complementors within platforms, offering services such as third-party software development kits (SDKs) for app developers, social media analytics tools for content creators, rental management software for hosts, and even fake review services for sellers. Although the presence and relevance of these actors have been largely overlooked in platform research, we demonstrate the importance of recognizing their distinctive role and their conflicting impacts on platform value architectures. Specifically, we theorize three mechanisms through which auxiliaries support complementors (augmenting their development and commercialization capabilities on the focal platform, increasing access to platform-specific information, and expanding their activities beyond the focal platform), discussing how they enhance complementors' engagement and innovation potential, thereby fostering generativity on the platform. Yet, because auxiliaries operate outside the architectural framework established by the platform owner, in supporting complementors, they may reshape fundamental channels underpinning architectural stability, such as platform curation, information distribution, and platform compatibility, potentially weakening the control mechanisms through which the platform owner manages the platform and captures value.

□ Cutolo - Hidden in Plain Sight Conceptualizing Platform Auxiliaries and Their Conflicting

3. Understanding and Addressing the Disruptive Impacts of Contemporary Climate Crises

Authors: Jaco Fourie, Markus A. Höllerer, Renate E. Meyer, Dennis Jancsary, Graham Dwyer, Martin Kornberger, Paul Spee

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70112](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70112)

Published: 2026-06-02

Keywords: collaborative capacity, collaborative governance, governance boundaries, scalar dimensions, transboundary crisis

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Crisis Management, Public Administration
- **Theories:** Transboundary Crisis Theory, Collaborative Governance

Abstract:

Abstract

Contemporary climate crises, such as wildfires, droughts, floods, and tropical storms, are increasing in frequency, intensity, scale, and duration. Organization and management scholars have been calling for more systematic study of the impacts of this increasing complexity on extant crisis governance arrangements and capacities for collaboration in response. We here bring together insights from organization and management studies and public administration research to investigate the disruptive impacts of the 2019-2020 'Black Summer' bushfires—a prototypical contemporary climate crisis. We conceptualize the complexity of such crises in terms of manifestation on, and across multiple, scalar dimensions (i.e., jurisdictional, functional [organizational, sectoral], spatial, cultural, and temporal dimensions) and mobilize transboundary crisis theory to explain how this disrupts the functioning of standing collaborative governance arrangements through five distinct mechanisms: stretching, blurring, fracturing, ossifying, and improvising. In turn, we synthesize a conceptual model of how these mechanisms interact to undermine collaborative capacity as crisis complexity increases. Our work bridges and extends ongoing debates in organization and management studies as well as public administration, offering a foundation for adaptation of crisis governance and response in a climate-changed future.

□ Fourie - Understanding and Addressing the Disruptive Impacts of Contemporary Climate Cris.pdf

Journal of Management

1. Rewriting the Imprint: How #MeToo Led CEOs From Male-Dominant Cultures to Increase Gender Equality

Authors: Michael J. Mueller, Taco H. Reus

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261449761](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261449761)

Published: 2026-06-06

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Imprinting Theory, Social Movement Theory

Abstract:

This paper examines how CEOs' cultural imprints shape women's representation in corporate leadership and how social movements can alter these effects. Building on imprinting theory, we argue that transformative social movements, such as the #MeToo movement, can create secondary sensitive periods during which deeply ingrained imprints are revisited and reinterpreted. Using a difference-in-differences design in the U.S. information and communications technology sector, we find that, before #MeToo, firms led by CEOs from male-dominant cultures employed fewer women in senior management. After the movement's emergence, however, these CEOs increased women's representation more strongly than their peers from more gender-egalitarian cultures. The effect persisted through 2024, was concentrated in male-typed roles, and was strongest among younger CEOs, consistent with intrinsic rather than purely extrinsic motives. Complementary analyses of employees' career trajectories, employee reviews, and CEO speech suggest that these

changes reflect shifts in promotion dynamics, organizational culture, and CEOs' emphasis on integrity and respect. Together, the findings show that social movements can prompt lasting behavioral change among leaders whose cultural imprints are most directly challenged.

□ Mueller - Rewriting the Imprint How #MeToo Led CEOs From Male-Dominant Cultures to Increased.pdf

2. To Compete From Within: The Competitive Dynamics of Resource Bundling

Authors: Reha Karadag, Danny Miller, Ming-Jer Chen

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261448465](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261448465)

Published: 2026-06-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Competitive Dynamics
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Competitive Dynamics, Resource Orchestration

Abstract:

The resource-based and competitive dynamics perspectives emphasize market activity in defining competition: Rivals compete in product and factor markets for customers and scarce resources. To address market opportunities, however, resources must be bundled into capabilities. Bundling represents the link between resources and value creation. Despite the competitive implications of resource bundling, the current literature implicitly assumes that firms take bundling actions in isolation, which does not reflect the phenomena in most industries, where rivals observe, react to, and learn from each other's bundling, potentially resulting in escalation. To address this gap, we explore the competitive drivers of bundling, which differs from market-oriented activities in its internal nature and how it escalates within and across markets. We posit that simultaneous overlap in factor and product markets can enhance the visibility of bundling activity, foster resource similarity, and create performance pressure among rivals, leading to a market-level "race to bundle" and differentiation in bundling. We also analyze the moderating roles of the focal firm's resource endowments relative to its rivals and the extent to which it overlaps with these rivals across factor markets. Based on over a million firm-month observations of 5,415 upstream oil and gas operators, we find that rivals bundling intensity is positively related to subsequent focal firm bundling intensity and nonconformity. These relationships are moderated by the firm's relative resource endowments and multi-factor market overlap. This important Acknowledgments: We thank Editor Hermann Ndofor and the anonymous reviewers for their constructive comments and guidance throughout the review process. We also appreciate the helpful feedback from Brian Wu, Fiona Yao, and Tieying Yu on earlier versions of the paper.

□ Karadag - To Compete From Within The Competitive Dynamics of Resource Bundling.pdf

3. Robustness Analysis in Quantitative Management Research: A Review and Recommendations

Authors: Shuai Yuan, Deanne N. Den Hartog, Yicun Liu, Annebel H.B. De Hoogh, Lujia (Sophia) Sun, Danqin Zhao, Katrin Riisla, Frank D. Belschak

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261440210](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261440210)

Published: 2026-06-05

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Management Research Methodology, Quantitative Methods, Strategic Management, Organizational Research
- **Theories:** Robustness Analysis Framework, Meta-research, Credibility-enhancing practices

Abstract:

Robustness analysis assesses the fragility or stability of empirical findings by testing whether research findings remain stable across alternative, justifiable analytical choices. Understanding the robustness of empirical results is important both for management scholars to build reliable theories and for management practitioners

ers to derive appropriate practical implications for decision-making. Yet, the management field currently faces three problems in designing and reporting robustness analysis: terminological confusion, fragmented recommendations across isolated topics without integration, and a lack of systematic evidence on actual reporting practices. This paper clarifies the concept of robustness analysis and distinguishes it from related credibility-enhancing practices. Using a framework encompassing six key dimensions of robustness (i.e., methods, measurements, covariates, preprocessing, subsampling, and statistical specifications), we review and synthesize the currently fragmented recommendations for each dimension. Next, to systematically review the reporting of robustness practices, we develop a hybrid Generative AI-assisted coding approach enabling the analysis of a larger volume of articles than feasible with human coding alone. In a systematic review of 1,706 articles containing 2,770 quantitative sub-studies published in seven leading management journals (2020–2025), we find that reporting of robustness analyses is often done narrowly and inconsistently, scattered across multiple article sections, and using different terms. Our findings reveal gaps between recommended and documented practices, between macro and micro domains, and across time periods. Based on the review results, we offer recommendations for conducting and reporting robustness analyses.

□ Yuan - Robustness Analysis in Quantitative Management Research A Review and Recommendation.

Academy of Management Annals

1. Lost in Translation: Where Is the Relational Context in Negotiation Research?

Authors: Mara Olekalns

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2024.0055](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2024.0055)

Published: 2026-06-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Negotiation
- **Theories:** Relational Perspective, Narrative Theory

Abstract:

Economic and psychological paradigms conceptualize negotiations as time-bounded events set apart from our organizational relationships. These paradigms yield a deep understanding of how negotiators can maximize their dealmaking effectiveness. They also constrain our understanding by abstracting negotiations from the ongoing relationships within which they are embedded. Deeper insight into negotiation dynamics requires a broader view, one that locates negotiations within their relational context. By distilling constructs from disciplines that offer this broader perspective, I identify three insights that expand our conceptualization of negotiation. First, the interaction between broad relationship and domain-specific negotiation narratives shapes how individuals approach negotiations and how they craft settlements. Second, embedding negotiations within a relationship trajectory highlights a recursive dynamic: relationship quality determines at-the-table tactics, and this experience spills over to transform the ongoing relationship. Third, relational tone—the what and how of interpersonal interactions—resets the between-negotiation relationship trajectory. This maintenance work establishes relationship expectations and facilitates (or impedes) convergence to shared narratives, becoming a critical input into subsequent negotiations. In conclusion, I discuss the unifying constructs that broaden negotiation theory, identify the pedagogical implications of a relational perspective, and outline the methodological expansion needed to benefit from these insights.

□ Olekalns - Lost in Translation Where Is the Relational Context in Negotiation Research.p
